

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET A — FOUNDATION & CORE CONCEPTS****CHAPTER 01: UNDERSTANDING SOCIAL SCIENCE**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-A-01

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET A - Foundation & Core Concepts):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
3. Each question offers four options: **(A), (B), (C), and (D)**. Select the single best answer.
4. Darken the corresponding circle on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

Q.1 What is the primary scope and objective of Social Science as an academic discipline?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) The study of natural physical phenomena and chemical reactions | (B) The study of human society, relationships, institutions, and human behavior across time and space |
| (C) The exclusive formulation of abstract mathematical theorems | (D) The technical design of industrial manufacturing machinery |

Q.2 Which of the following disciplines studies the spatial distribution of physical features, climates, and human populations across the Earth?

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| (A) Archaeology | (B) Geography |
| (C) Epigraphy | (D) Numismatics |

Q.3 Which category of historical evidence includes original handwritten manuscripts, official royal charters, and contemporary inscriptions produced during the period under study?

- | | |
|-----------------------|------------------------|
| (A) Secondary sources | (B) Tertiary sources |
| (C) Primary sources | (D) Fictional accounts |

Q.4 The scientific study and decipherment of ancient inscriptions engraved on stone slabs, pillars, and copper plates is known as:

- | | |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Numismatics | (B) Epigraphy |
| (C) Palaeontology | (D) Cartography |

Q.5 The study and collection of ancient coins, medals, and monetary tokens to reconstruct trade routes and dynasties is termed:

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| (A) Numismatics | (B) Archaeology |
| (C) Chronology | (D) Sociology |

Q.6 Which branch of Social Science is primarily concerned with the allocation of scarce resources to satisfy unlimited human needs and wants?

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------|
| (A) Political Science | (B) Economics |
| (C) Anthropology | (D) Demography |

Q.7 Political Science focuses principally on the study of:

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) Fossils and evolutionary biological origins | (B) The state, governance, constitution, power dynamics, and rights of citizens |
| (C) The atmospheric layers and oceanic currents | (D) Ancient ceramic styles and pottery residues |

Q.8 What method do historians and social scientists use to overcome bias and verify the authenticity of a historical claim?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Relying solely on folk legends and unverified rumors | (B) Cross-referencing multiple independent primary and secondary sources |
| (C) Accepting the most dramatic and sensational version | (D) Discarding all written records in favor of guesswork |

Q.9 A textbook or modern scholarly biography written by a 21st-century historian about Emperor Ashoka is classified as a:

- | | |
|---------------------------|----------------------|
| (A) Primary source | (B) Secondary source |
| (C) Archaeological fossil | (D) Epigraphic relic |

Q.10 Why is an interdisciplinary approach crucial in Social Science?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Because social issues involve interconnected historical, geographical, political, and economic dimensions | (B) To prove that only one single discipline is scientifically valid |
| (C) To eliminate the need for field investigation and factual evidence | (D) Because physical sciences cannot study planets |

Q.11 The systematic excavation of physical material remains such as tools, pottery, architecture, and bones is carried out by:

- | | |
|-------------------|--------------------|
| (A) Sociologists | (B) Archaeologists |
| (C) Cartographers | (D) Economists |

Q.12 Oral traditions, folklore, and spoken testimonies passed down through generations are especially valuable when:

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Written textual records are completely absent or restricted to elite classes | (B) Physical artifacts are too well-preserved |
| (C) Official royal court chronicles already explain every detail | (D) Scientific carbon dating is completely infallible |

Q.13 The scientific technique used by archaeologists to estimate the absolute age of organic remains up to roughly 50,000 years old is:

- | | |
|------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| (A) Radiocarbon dating (Carbon-14) | (B) Potassium-argon dating |
| (C) Stratigraphy | (D) Thermoluminescence |

Q.14 In Social Science research, what does 'ethical responsibility' require a researcher to do?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Falsify data to match popular opinion | (B) Respect human dignity, protect confidentiality, and report evidence truthfully |
| (C) Suppress any findings that contradict preconceived theories | (D) Plagiarize historical documents without attribution |

Q.15 The study of human population statistics including birth rates, death rates, migration, and age composition is known as:

- | | |
|----------------|-----------------|
| (A) Demography | (B) Cartography |
| (C) Geology | (D) Ethnography |

Q.16 Which discipline explores cultural norms, kinship patterns, rituals, and the evolution of diverse human societies?

- | | |
|------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Anthropology | (B) Meteorology |
| (C) Astronomy | (D) Botany |

Q.17 How does learning Social Science contribute to responsible democratic citizenship?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) It discourages citizens from questioning public policies | (B) It fosters critical thinking, civic awareness, empathy, and respect for constitutional values |
| (C) It forces all citizens to memorize dates without comprehension | (D) It promotes unquestioning obedience to totalitarian regimes |

Q.18 Which of the following is considered an archival document?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) A modern plastic replica of a toy car | (B) An official treaty parchment preserved in the National Archives |
| (C) A fictional mythological novel written last year | (D) A freshly printed roadside advertising flyer |

Q.19 What is 'historiography'?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) The drawing of nautical maps | (B) The study of how historical writing, perspectives, and interpretations have developed over time |
| (C) The physical excavation of ancient burial mounds | (D) The measurement of rainfall using rain gauges |

Q.20 When a geographer studies both natural landforms and how human settlements modify the landscape, the field is called:

- | | |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| (A) Human-Environment Geography | (B) Pure Geophysics |
| (C) Theoretical Astrophysics | (D) Paleobotany |

Q.21 Why must social scientists consider the 'context' of an author when reading an ancient chronicle?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Because all ancient writers wrote exactly the same thoughts | (B) Because court chronicles often reflected royal patronage, political interests, and contemporary worldviews |
| (C) To prove that ancient languages had no grammar | (D) Because ancient paper was made of cotton |

Q.22 The principle that all human societies evolve through ongoing adaptations to changing technological, social, and economic environments is a core tenet of:

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|-----------------|
| (A) Sociology and Historical Analysis | (B) Meteorology |
| (C) Astrophysics | (D) Geometry |

Q.23 Which of the following best represents a qualitative data collection method in Social Science?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Conducting in-depth open-ended oral history interviews | (B) Measuring annual rainfall in millimeters |
| (C) Calculating the gross domestic product using national accounts | (D) Counting the number of registered voters in an electoral roll |

Q.24 Which of the following is an example of an artifact?

- | | |
|---|---|
| (A) A naturally occurring granite boulder on a mountain ridge | (B) A polished terracotta bead manufactured by a Harappan artisan |
| (C) A fossilized ammonite shell from the Jurassic period | (D) A volcanic crater formed by lava eruption |

Q.25 How does understanding Social Science help address contemporary global challenges like climate change and poverty?

- (A) By identifying social patterns, economic incentives, governance frameworks, and collaborative human solutions
- (B) By claiming that social issues have no connection to human action
- (C) By replacing all scientific data with superstition
- (D) By advising governments to ignore vulnerable communities

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET A)

01	(A) (B) (C) (D)	02	(A) (B) (C) (D)	03	(A) (B) (C) (D)	04	(A) (B) (C) (D)	05	(A) (B) (C) (D)
06	(A) (B) (C) (D)	07	(A) (B) (C) (D)	08	(A) (B) (C) (D)	09	(A) (B) (C) (D)	10	(A) (B) (C) (D)
11	(A) (B) (C) (D)	12	(A) (B) (C) (D)	13	(A) (B) (C) (D)	14	(A) (B) (C) (D)	15	(A) (B) (C) (D)
16	(A) (B) (C) (D)	17	(A) (B) (C) (D)	18	(A) (B) (C) (D)	19	(A) (B) (C) (D)	20	(A) (B) (C) (D)
21	(A) (B) (C) (D)	22	(A) (B) (C) (D)	23	(A) (B) (C) (D)	24	(A) (B) (C) (D)	25	(A) (B) (C) (D)

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET A)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.1	(B)	Social Science is the systematic study of human society, social relationships, human behavior, civic institutions, economic systems, and historical evolution.
Q.2	(B)	Geography is the study of Earth's physical environments, landforms, atmospheres, and the spatial distribution of human populations and their interaction with the environment.
Q.3	(C)	Primary sources are first-hand, contemporary records created during the time period under study, such as inscriptions, coins, royal edicts, and original letters.
Q.4	(B)	Epigraphy is the scientific discipline that deals with the study and decipherment of inscriptions carved on stone, metal, or other durable materials.
Q.5	(A)	Numismatics is the study of coins, currencies, and medals, providing crucial information about kings, dates, metallurgical skills, and economic trade networks.
Q.6	(B)	Economics analyzes how individuals, firms, and governments make choices to allocate scarce resources among competing alternatives.
Q.7	(B)	Political Science explores the theory and practice of politics, the functioning of government systems, constitutional structures, and the rights and duties of citizens.
Q.8	(B)	Rigorous historical methodology requires corroborating and cross-referencing multiple independent sources (inscriptions, texts, archaeology) to establish historical accuracy.
Q.9	(B)	A secondary source is created by someone who did not experience first-hand or participate in the events, but analyzes and interprets primary sources.
Q.10	(A)	Human societies are complex; an event like a migration or famine requires geographical, economic, historical, and political insights to understand fully.
Q.11	(B)	Archaeology is the scientific study of human history and prehistory through the excavation of sites and analysis of artifacts and physical remains.
Q.12	(A)	Oral history captures the lived experiences of marginalized groups and societies that lacked written scripts or formal archives.
Q.13	(A)	Radiocarbon dating measures the decay of the radioactive isotope Carbon-14 in organic materials like wood, charcoal, bone, and seeds.
Q.14	(B)	Ethical social research requires honesty, integrity, informed consent, respect for cultural diversity, and objective reporting of evidence.
Q.15	(A)	Demography is the statistical study of human populations, including size, density, distribution, fertility, mortality, and migration patterns.
Q.16	(A)	Anthropology is the scientific study of humans, human behavior, cultures, societies, and both past and present linguistic and physical development.
Q.17	(B)	Social Science cultivates analytical thinking, understanding of rights and duties, tolerance of diverse views, and active participation in democratic processes.
Q.18	(B)	Archives preserve primary historical government records, state treaties, royal decrees, gazettes, and authentic administrative correspondence.
Q.19	(B)	Historiography is the study of historical methodology and how interpretations of the past change across different historical eras and viewpoints.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Human-Environment Geography examines the reciprocal interactions between environmental processes and human societal adaptations and modifications.
Q.21	(B)	Court chroniclers wrote under the patronage of monarchs, meaning their narratives must be read with awareness of potential political bias and contemporary perspectives.
Q.22	(A)	Sociological and historical inquiry explores how institutions, values, and practices transform as societies adopt new tools, economic modes, and ideas.
Q.23	(A)	Qualitative research involves descriptive, narrative, and interpretive methods such as interviews, participant observation, and textual analysis.
Q.24	(B)	An artifact is an object made, modified, or used by human beings, particularly an item of cultural or historical interest.
Q.25	(A)	Solving global crises requires understanding human behavior, economic policies, equitable resource distribution, and democratic policymaking.